How we develop, adopt and maintain MANRS documents: The MANRS Development Process

Di Ma

MANRS Steering Committee Member

2026.3.18 @ IETF125 Shenzhen

Why is Routing Security Hard?

Every network has a responsibility to implement basic routing security practices to mitigate threats.

But implementing best practices does not bring many immediate benefits. It costs time and money, and you probably can't charge extra for it.

Even if you do everything right, your security is still in the hands of other networks.

This is a classic collective action problem.

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We Are In This Together

Network operators have a responsibility to ensure a globally robust and secure routing infrastructure.

Your network's safety depends on a routing infrastructure that weeds out bad actors and accidental misconfigurations that wreak havoc on the Internet.

The more network operators work together, the fewer incidents there will be, and the less damage they can do.

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The Solution: Mutually Agreed Norms for Routing Security (MANRS)

Provides crucial fixes to reduce the most common routing threats

MANRS improves the security and reliability of the global Internet routing system, based on collaboration among participants and shared responsibility for the Internet infrastructure.

MANRS sets a new norm for routing security.

Mutually Agreed Norms for Routing Security

Industry-led initiative of 1000+ participating networks to implement best practices and collaborate toward a shared vision of a secure routing infrastructure.

MANRS provides concrete actions for Network Operators, IXPs, CDN/Cloud Providers, and Equipment Vendors to reduce or eliminate the most common threats to routing.

There are no fees to join MANRS.

The Steering Committee is comprised of individuals elected by the MANRS community to coordinate and develop the MANRS initiative.

MANRS is supported by the Global Cyber Alliance.

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MANRS is maturing

In developing MANRS we as a community have always strived for transparency, inclusion and consensus: working groups, task forces, community last calls

To expand its impact further we need a formal process of how MANRS documents – normative (e.g. MANRS Actions) and informational (e.g. MANRS Implementation Guides) – are developed, adopted and maintained.

- Increase credibility, transparency and inclusiveness
  - A formal documented process for developing and modifying MANRS documents – MANRS Actions, MANRS Charter, etc.
- Introduce a formal document series
  - Provides stable references and version control, making it easier to refer to it in external documents

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OBSERVATORY

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MANRS PUBLICATIONS I NEWS AND ANNOUNCEMENTS

Approved: MANRS Development Process

By Megan Kruse • 9 Apr 2025

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https://manrs.org/2025/04/approved-mdp/

Bringing All MANRS Specifications Under the MANRS Development Process

1. MANRS standards are mandatory for the MANRS participants.

2. MANRS may also develop other informational, rather than normative, specifications, such as implementation guides.

Document ID	Name	Specification Type	Publication Date
MANRS-007.01	MANRS Network Operators Program Implementation Guide	Informational	December 11, 2025
MANRS-002.02	MANRS Community Charter	Normative	July 24, 2025
MANRS-001.01	MANRS Development Process	Normative	April 4, 2025
MANRS-008.01	MANRS IXP Program Implementation Guide	Informational	October 20, 2022
MANRS-009.01	Common ROA Management Requirements and Security Standards for Operators of RPKI Services (ORS)	Informational	November 2, 2021
MANRS-006.01	MANRS Actions for Equipment Vendor Program	Normative	September 16, 2021
MANRS-003.01	MANRS Actions for Network Operators Program	Normative	May 17, 2021
MANRS-005.01	MANRS Actions for CDN and Cloud Provider Program	Normative	March 1, 2021
MANRS-004.01	MANRS Actions for IXP Program	Normative	April 23, 2018

https://manrs.org/specifications/

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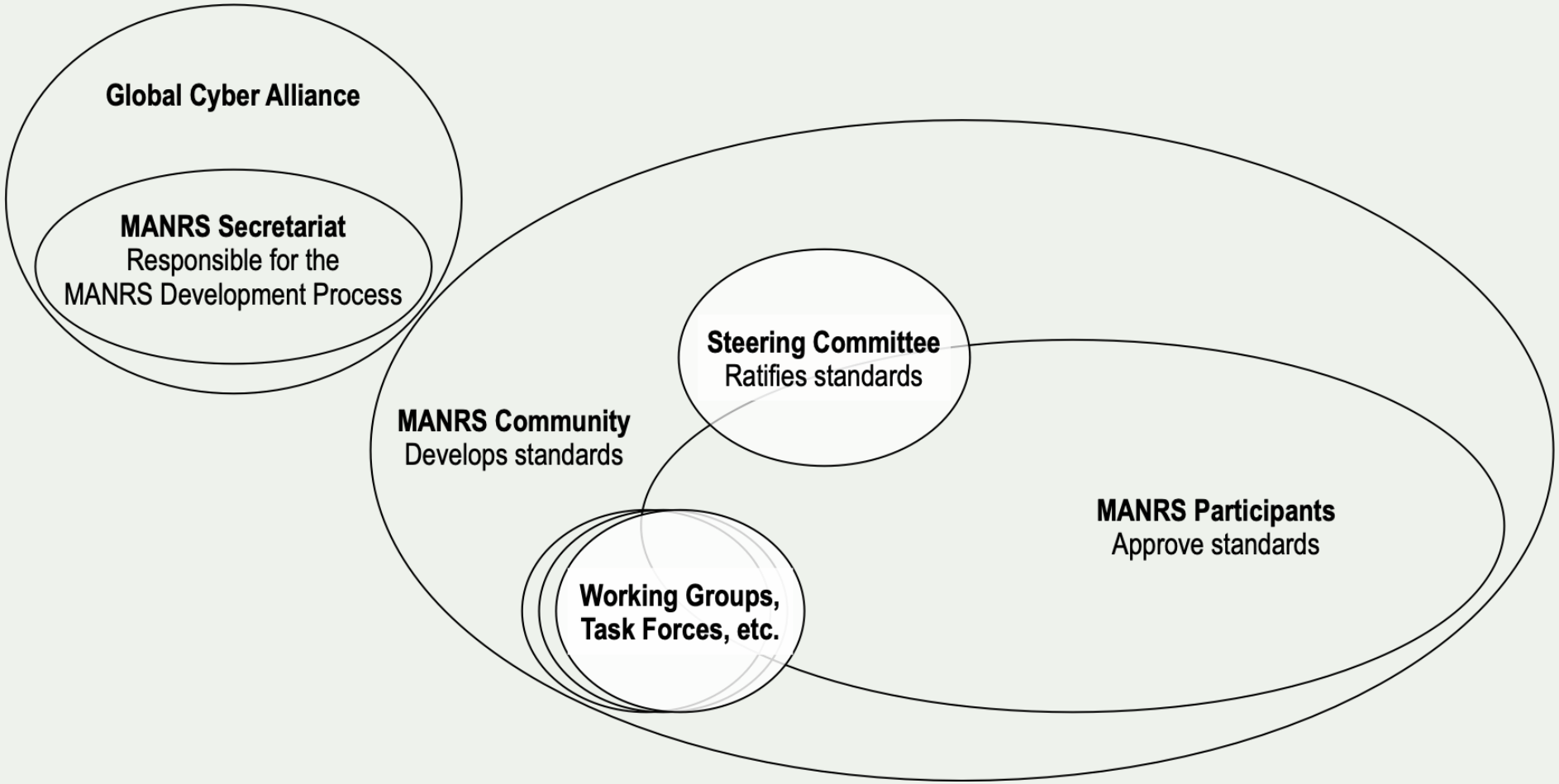
The MANRS Ecosystem in the context of the MDP



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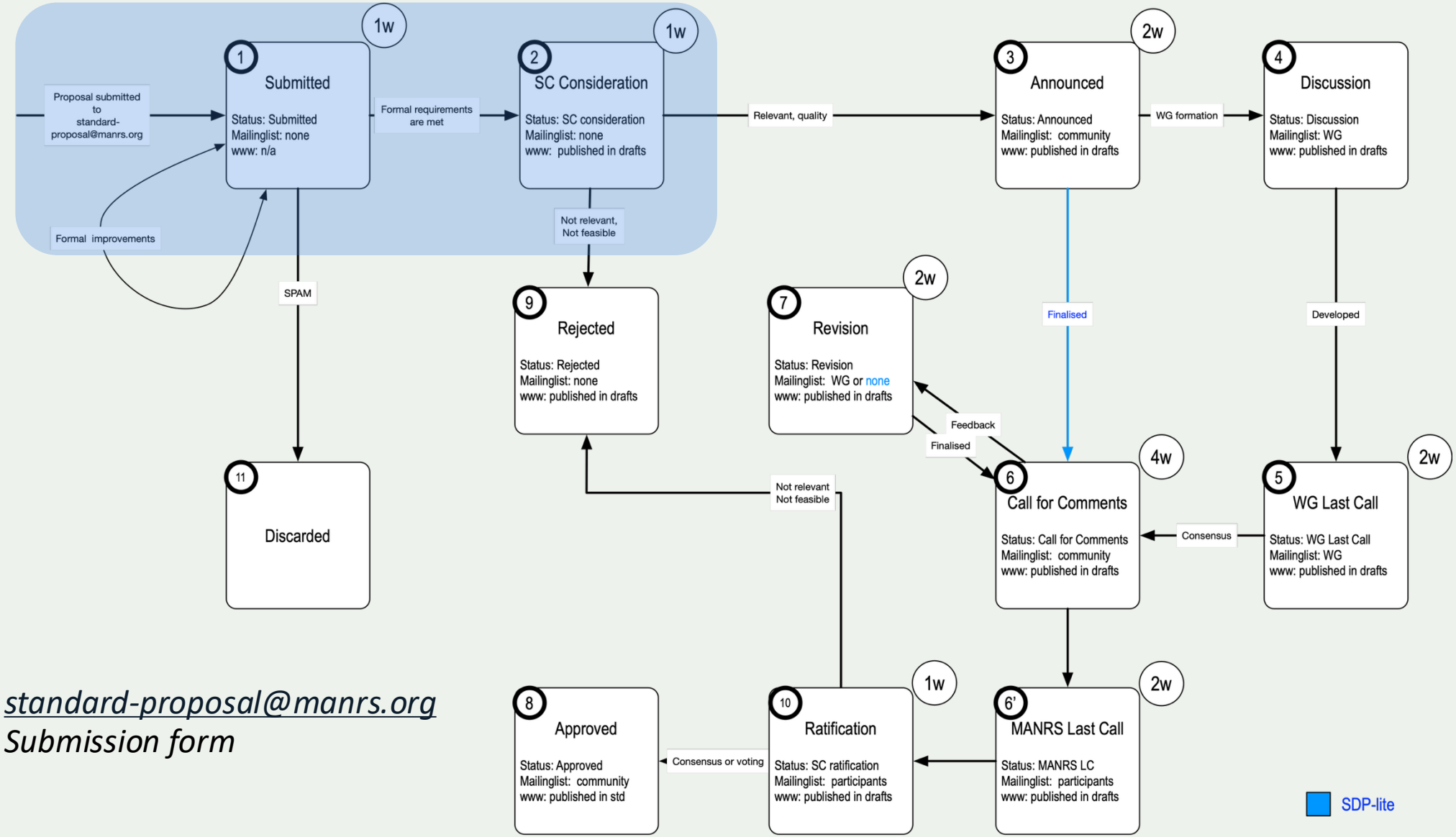
Proposal for a new standard development



- *standard-proposal@manrs.org*
- *Submission form*

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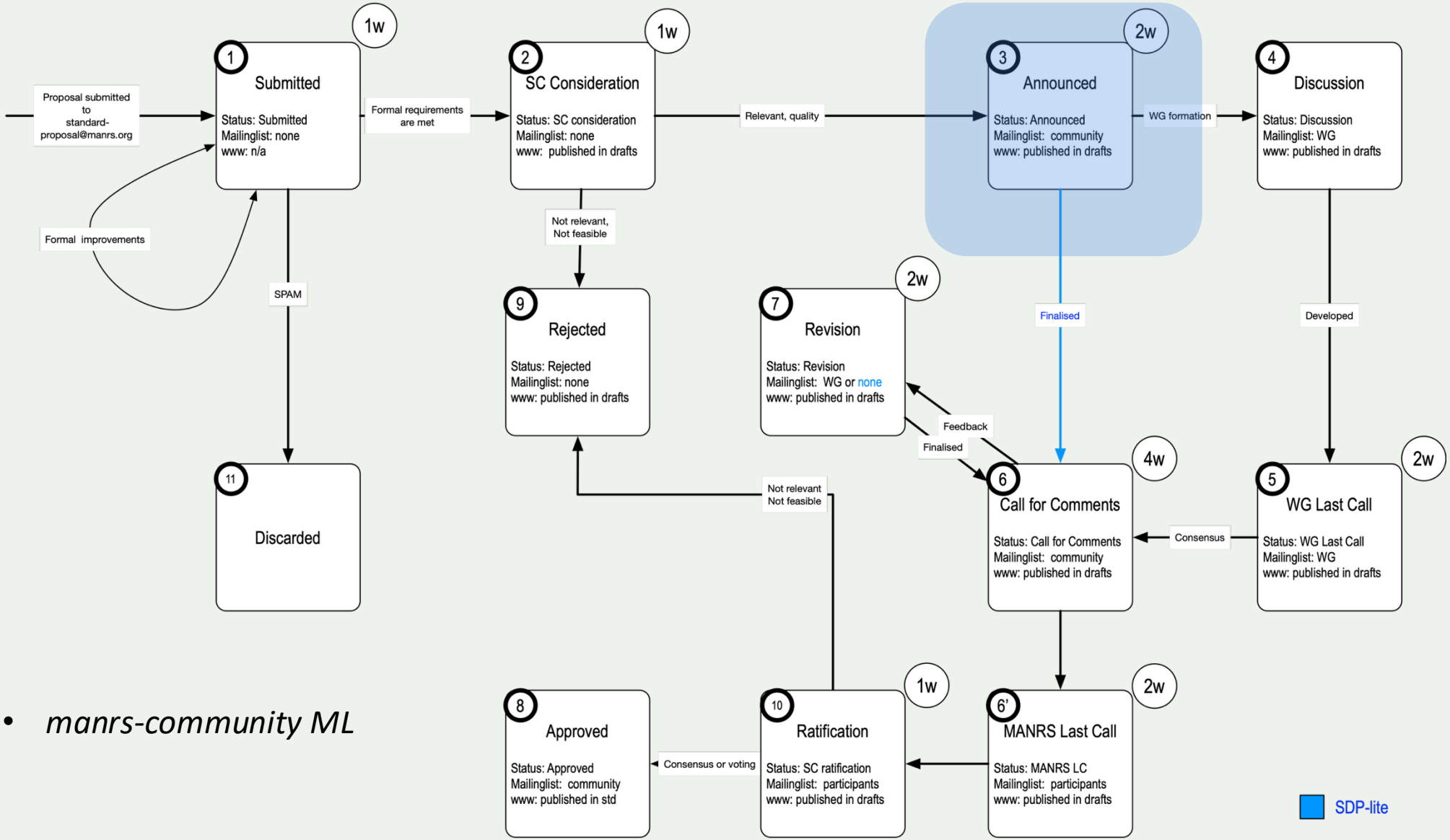
Announcement of new standard development



- *manrs-community ML*

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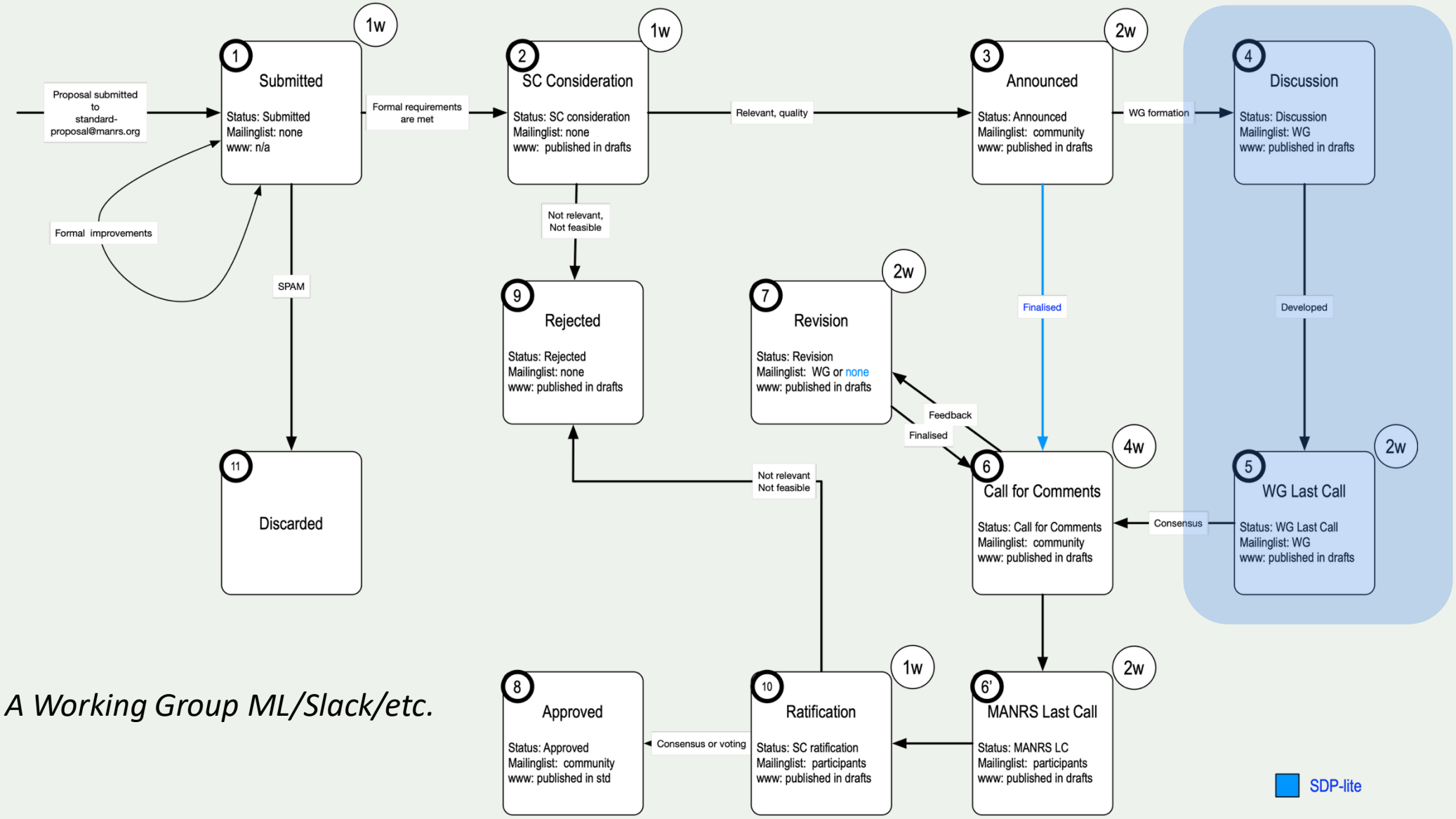
Development of a draft standard



- *A Working Group ML/Slack/etc.*

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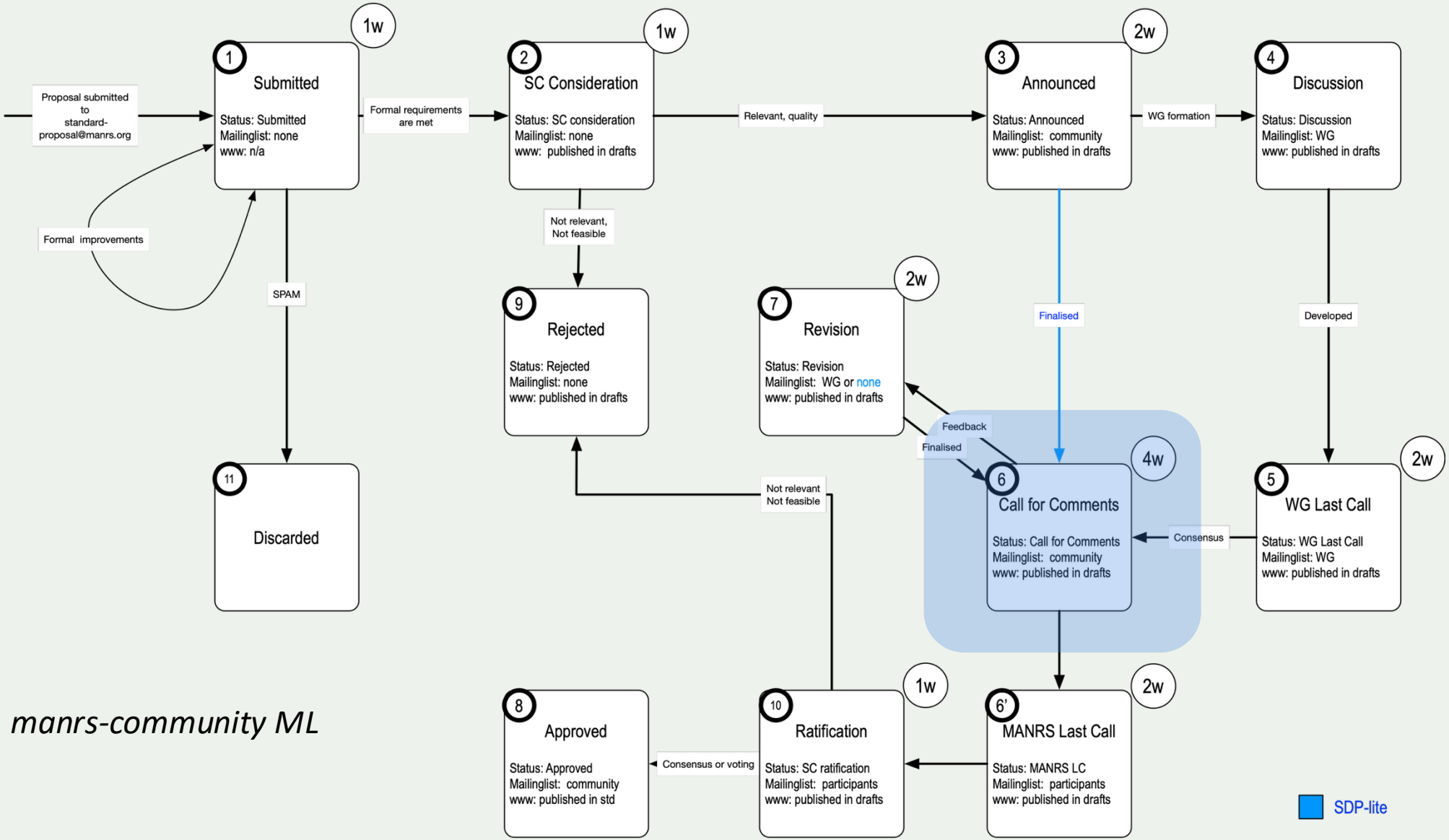
Call for comments



- *manrs-community ML*

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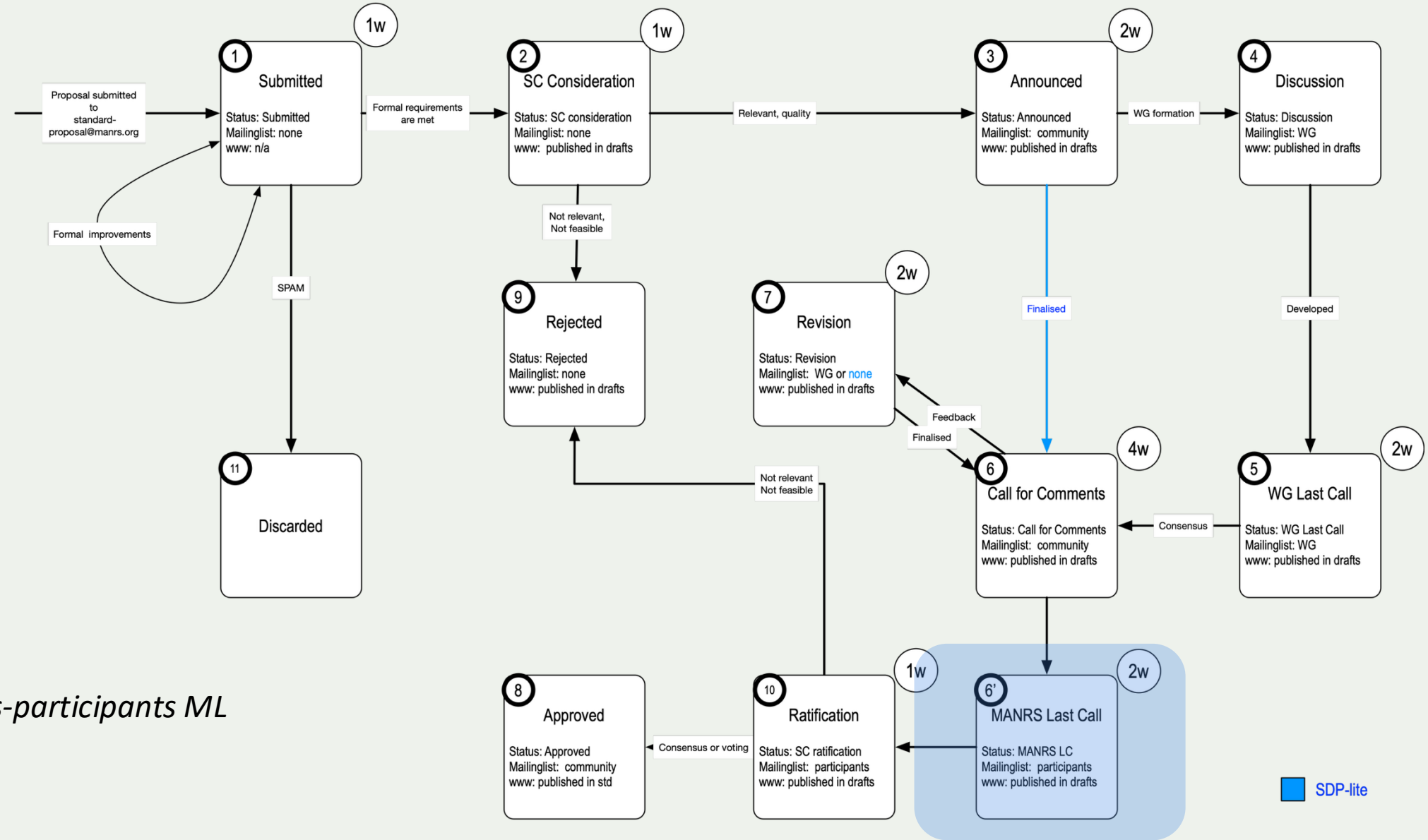
MANRS Last Call



- *manrs-participants ML*

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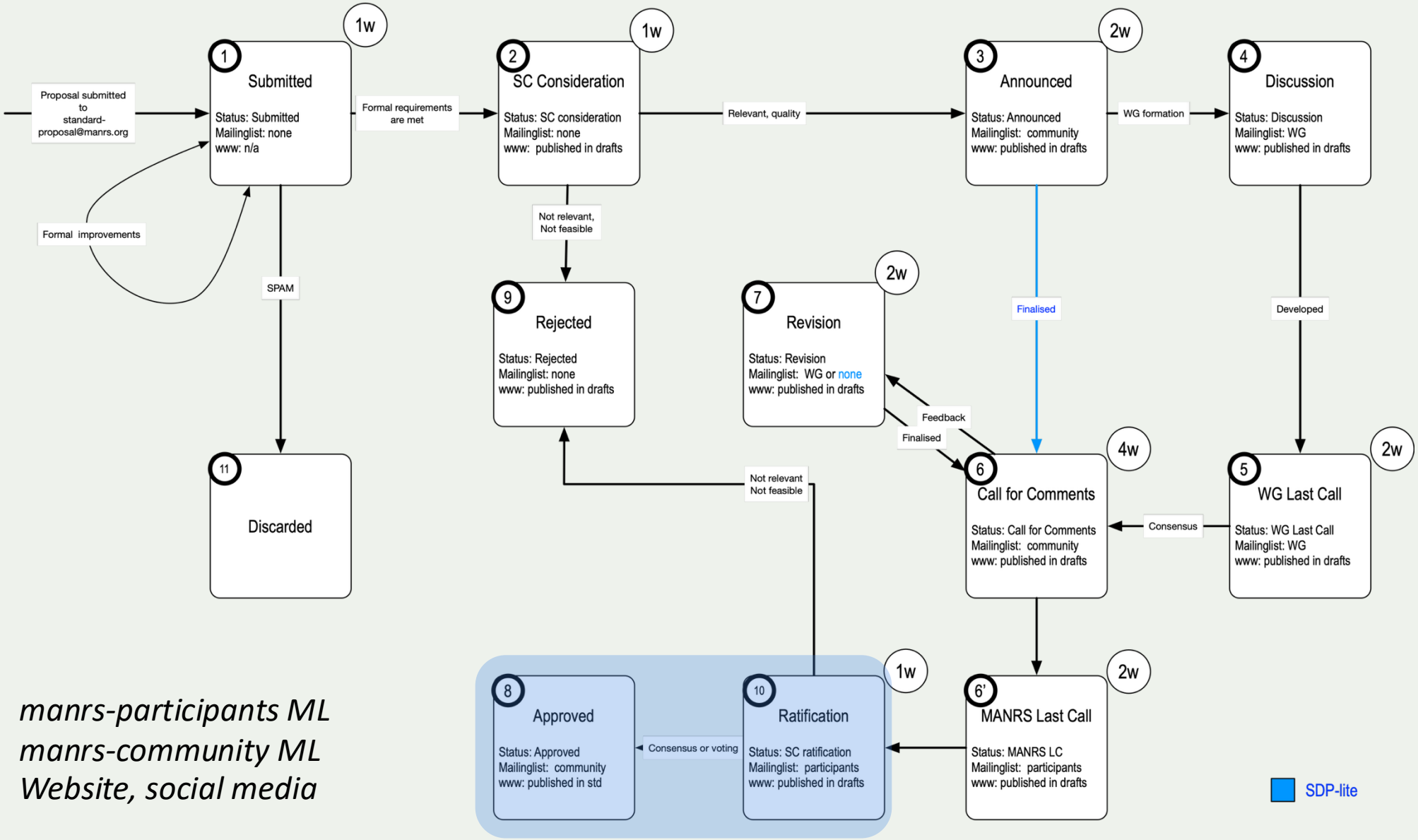
Ratification and publication of a standard



- *manrs-participants ML*
- *manrs-community ML*
- *Website, social media*

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Thanks.

Find more about MDP via

https://manrs.org/specifications/MANRS-001/01/